

having that money. I don't do that, but I try to put chunks of money in whenever I get paid enough. Then, I *Eternal Sunshine* it from my memory.

There are other income streams available for when you retire, like Social Security, for example. The average Social Security income is \$16,320 a year, but that's not really enough for the average person to live comfortably on. So an American retiree, excluding Social Security and assuming the 22.5-year-figure is correct, needs 1.3 million for retirement, just like Klontz said. And this is just an estimate, which gets higher if you get sick or with any other extenuating circumstance, but even the "low" \$1.3 million seems distant and impossible.

"If you don't have a million dollars in your life, how can you have a million dollars saved up as a retiree?!" I asked Sokunbi. "That seems nuts!"

"If you can save only a dollar every paycheck, save a dollar," Sokunbi said. She recalled trying to start saving money herself in a way I was too ashamed to do until recently. She had one extra dollar in her checking account that she tried to transfer to savings. It was too little money for an online transfer, so she took the one dollar and drove to the bank to deposit it without embarrassment. (Dang, girl!)

"It's not about the amount, the one dollar; it's about building the habit and the consistency of putting money aside because if you can't save when you have a little, you're not going to save when you have a lot of money," she said.

Sokunbi told me that even pennies on the street add up (I have a penny jar in my kitchen! Am I doing this right?), and once you're motivated to save, you'll make other changes, like thinking about your expenses and cutting down specifically to contribute to retirement savings. Saving needs to become second nature. Even if you save \$1 a week for two years like Sokunbi used to, you have \$104 that you didn't have before. The retirement system obviously isn't designed for everyone to succeed, so Sokunbi's advice is to just forget the system and do what you can individually.

"Does that mean earning more money? Does that mean cutting down on your expenses? Does that mean getting a part-time job? Does that mean starting